CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

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Task 4: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A: Case Study

Crime Type: Phishing What

is Phishing?

Phishing istype of cybercrime where attackers impersonate leg itimate organisations, such as banks, universities, or companies,
to trick individuals into sharing sensitive information like pass words, credit card details, or one-time passwords (OTPs).

Fictional Scenario:

Rahul is a first-year engineering student at a college. One evening, he receives an email that appears to be from his college's IT department. The subject line reads: "URGENT: Your college email account will be deactivated in 24 hours."

The email looks official —
it has the college logo, proper formatting, and

a link that says "Verify Now."
Worried about losing access to his email,
Rahul clicks the link without thinking. The website that opens l ooks exactly like his college's login page. He enters his email ID and password.

Within hours,
Rahul's friends start receiving strange messages from his account asking for money.
Someone has taken over his email and is now using it to scam others. Rahul realises his mistake, but the damage is already done — his account is compromised, and his personal information is in the hands of scammers.

How Phishing Typically Happens:

1. The victim receives an email, SMS, or WhatsApp message that appears to be from a trusted source.
2. The message creates urgency — "Your account will be blocked" or "You have won a prize."
3. A fake link leads to a website that looks identical to the real one.
4. When the victim enters their credentials, the attacker captures this information.
5. The attacker uses this information to access accounts, steal money, or commit identity theft.

Who Is Targeted:

Students are often targeted with fake scholarship offers, int ernship opportunities, or urgent messages claiming to be from college administration.

Consequences:

Victims may lose money, have their accounts hacked, or become victims of identity theft. In Rahul's case, his compromised email was used to scam his own friends.